

Brazil macro: one conditional trade

Rates, the real and commodity exports

Fixed research snapshot: 2026-09-01T21:40:27-03:00 · EN

A smaller Brazil-U.S. rate gap could weaken the real. My saved view is to wait: consider buying USD only above 5.22, with rates confirmation. Stronger commodity exports could overturn the idea.

OBSERVED · SAVED DATA

USD/BRL PTAX midpoint 5.1567 BRL / USD 2026-09-01	Selic target 14.00 % 2026-09-01
Brazil-U.S. policy gap 10.375 pp 2026-09-01	U.S. two-year yield 4.34 % 2026-08-31

SCENARIOS · ASSUMPTIONS

Saved September 2026 cases, not forecasts with assigned probabilities. The base case reflects the saved pricing anchors; FX effects are conditional, all else equal. An expected decision alone is not a new trading edge.

Hawkish relative to expectations

Copom: Hold 14.00%; restrictive bias · FOMC: Hold 3.50%-3.75%; firm guidance

Likely unchanged near 10.38 pp · Likely BRL strength / USD-BRL lower

Evidence to watch: Focus Selic toward 14.00%; PTAX below 5.09 with US 2Y lower

Base case

Copom: Cut 25 bp to 13.75%; cautious · FOMC: Hike 25 bp to 3.75%-4.00%; data-dependent

Likely narrows 50 bp to 9.88 pp · Likely BRL weakness / USD-BRL higher

Evidence to watch: Targets imply 9.88 pp; PTAX above 5.22 with US 2Y firm

Dovish relative to expectations

Copom: Cut 50 bp to 13.50%; easing bias · FOMC: Hike 25 bp to 3.75%-4.00%; firm bias

Likely narrows 75 bp to 9.63 pp · Likely BRL weakness / USD-BRL higher

Evidence to watch: Focus Selic below 13.75%; PTAX above 5.22 with US 2Y higher

PAPER TRADE · CONDITIONAL RULES

No position at the saved snapshot; subsequent activation is not monitored.

Enter only on a confirmed upside break in USD/BRL because the exchange-aligned base case narrows the Brazil-US policy differential while recent PTAX, Focus Selic and US 2-year moves already lean in the same direction.

Entry / confirmation

No position at the 5.1567 snapshot. Consider the paper trade only after a daily PTAX midpoint closes above approximately 5.22, the rounded high of the latest 20 valid observations (5.2233), with the US 2-year yield still near or above 4.34% or the policy differential not widening.

Invalidation / after entry

Invalidate after entry if PTAX records two consecutive daily midpoints below approximately 5.16, the rounded midpoint of the saved 20-observation range (5.1569), or if the Brazil-US policy differential fails to narrow and remains near or above 10.375 pp because Copom does not ease and the FOMC does not hike.

Review zone / not a target

Add the unrounded saved 20-observation high (5.2233) to the unrounded saved range width (0.1328) to obtain 5.3561, then bracket that measured move to the adjacent-cent 5.35-5.36 review zone; take profit earlier if post-meeting data reverse the differential or US 2-year confirmation.

Catalyst / timing

Both meetings run on 15-16 September 2026; decisions are scheduled for 16 September. Reassess the idea after the announcements and their guidance.

Main risks: Brazil keeps rates higher; the Fed does not hike; fiscal improvement, stronger exports or global risk appetite support BRL. Already-priced decisions may produce little reaction.

PTAX is an official daily reference, not a live or executable spot quote. Levels are rounded research rules; 5.22 is slightly below the exact saved high of 5.2233. Costs, slippage and position sizing are not modelled.

COMMODITIES · A CROSS-CHECK

Oil · 95.29 USD / barrel · +3.1%

2026-08-18 / compared with 2026-08-17 · EIA / FRED

Oil can lift export income but also fuel inflation.

Iron ore · 101.60 USD / tonne · -2.1%

2026-07 / compared with 2026-06 · IMF / FRED

Iron ore connects export receipts to steel demand, especially in China.

Soybeans · 426.33 USD / tonne · +4.9%

Q2 2026 / compared with Q1 2026 · IMF / FRED

Soybeans bring export dollars; harvest timing and demand shape flows.

Sugar · 14.81 US cents / lb · +6.5%

2026-07 / compared with 2026-06 · IMF / FRED

Sugar competes with ethanol for cane, linking exports to fuel economics.

METHOD AND SOURCE LIMITS

Focus is a survey, not a policy commitment. The policy gap subtracts the Fed target-range midpoint from Selic; it is not an investment return. Commodity prices have different observation periods. The PDF is generated from saved files and does not update automatically.

Research horizon: approximately two to four weeks around the September meetings. The base case supports the idea; the more restrictive relative-rate case invalidates it.

B3: 1 September 2026; about 21.8 basis points of easing estimated from DI futures, not a published Copom probability. CME: 1 September 2026, 02:07 CT; the final refresh failed. These saved inputs are not current pricing. No joint probability is assigned.

USD/BRL changed +1.57% over approximately one month in the saved data. A rise means the dollar strengthened against the real; the inverse BRL/USD return has a different magnitude.

Hawkish relative to expectations

A global risk-off or commodity shock could weaken BRL even with a more favorable relative-rate outcome.

Base case

The paired moves may already be reflected in rates and FX, leaving global risk appetite, commodities or fiscal news as the dominant driver.

Dovish relative to expectations

A larger Copom cut could be read as a credibility error, lifting local risk premia and front-end rates rather than producing the assumed orderly easing reaction.

Economists' 2026 Brazil-rate forecast fell 0.25 percentage point over one month, while their inflation forecast edged lower.

The real weakened 0.16% against the dollar over the latest five observations.

Brazil's interest-rate advantage over the U.S. narrowed 0.25 percentage point over one month.

Official sources

[BCB · Focus](#)

[BCB · Selic / SGS 432](#)

[BCB · Copom](#)

[FRED · DGS2](#)

[B3 · DI1](#)

[FRED · DGS10](#)

[IMF / FRED · PIORECRUSDM](#)

[IMF / FRED · PSUGAISAUSDM](#)

[BCB · PTAX](#)

[Federal Reserve · FOMC](#)

[FRED · DFEDTARL](#)

[CME FedWatch](#)

[FRED · DFEDTARU](#)

[EIA / FRED · DCOILBRENTU](#)

[IMF / FRED · PSOYBUSDQ](#)

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